

Even though frank money discussions are uncomfortable, they are necessary. A regular time should be set aside for discussing money. It is recommended to have the facts and figures on paper. This will result in the discussions being shorter, calmer, and more productive. Cliff's discovery of Jennifer's planned spending wouldn't have necessarily meant the marriage would have been called off, but it might have impacted many of their financial decisions. Maybe the wedding would have been scaled down or they wouldn't have taken such an expensive honeymoon. Regardless, they would have tackled their money problems sooner rather than later.

Cliff and Jennifer should have worked out a budget prior to planning for their wedding. The following is a sample wedding budget:

Expenses	Amount
Invitations	
Announcements	
Thank you cards	
Formal portraits	
Photographer	
Videography	
Limousines	
Bridal luncheon	
Rehearsal dinner	
Travel for out-of-town guests	
Church/synagogue fees	
Food	
Beverages	
Wedding cake	
Valet parking	
Music/Band	

